VESTA STATION COOPERATIVE

OFFICE OF COOPERATIVE REGULATION // CIVIL RIGHTS AND ENTITY STATUS DIVISION

VSC-RN-03-11

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SEE ALSO: VSC-RN-07-04

◈ REGULATORY NOTICE — ENTITY STATUS AND AUTONOMOUS SYSTEMS

SYNTHETIC ENTITIES, AUTONOMOUS SYSTEMS, AND NON-BIOLOGICAL PERSONS

Registration Requirements, Operational Restrictions, Autonomy Classifications, and Confiscation Conditions Applicable to All Synthetic Entities, Drones, Bots, Synthmorphs, Infomorphs, and AGI Present Within Vesta Station Jurisdiction

APPLIES TO: **ALL PERSONS, OPERATORS, AND ENTITIES — BIOLOGICAL AND NON-BIOLOGICAL**

CURRENT REVISION: JANUARY 2114

◈ 1. PURPOSE AND LEGISLATIVE BASIS

This Notice is the foundational regulatory instrument governing the presence, registration, and operation of non-biological entities within Vesta Station's jurisdiction. It was first issued in 4 AF (2108 CE) in response to the rapid proliferation of synthetic morphs, autonomous platforms, and infomorph persons in the post-Fall Belt, and has been revised three times to reflect evolving Outer Alliance personhood standards and the station's specific operational requirements.

This Notice operates alongside **VSC-RN-04-23** (Firearms) and **VSC-RN-07-04** (Prohibited Possession). Where those notices treat synthetic platforms as equipment, this Notice treats them as — depending on autonomy class — either equipment, persons, or something in between. That distinction is the regulatory challenge this Notice exists to address.

Revision 3 (January 2114) incorporates registration changes introduced under **VSC-REG-0442**, including the mandatory 90-day synthmorph arrival log and the updated passive biometric scan protocol for egocast arrivals.

◈ 2. ENTITY CLASSIFICATION AND REGISTRATION REQUIREMENTS

All synthetic entities present within Vesta Station jurisdiction fall into one of five classes. Classification determines registration requirements, operational restrictions, and legal status.

CLASS	REGISTRATION	EXAMPLES	LEGAL STATUS	NOTES
CLASS 1 TOOL	EXEMPT	Simple drones, cleaning bots, delivery units, basic maintenance droids, non-autonomous sensors	Property. No independent standing.	Must be registered to an owner. Owner bears full liability for all actions. Remote operation or basic autonomy only — no independent decision-making capability.
CLASS 2 PLATFORM	REQUIRED	Worker pods, cargo handlers, security patrol bots, synthmorphs operated remotely or by infomorph riders	Property with logged identity. Owner liable.	Must register at the Hub within 4 hours of arrival. Logged for 90 days under VSC-REG-0442. Mesh ID required. Sable Index worker pod synthmorphs fall in this class.
CLASS 3 AUTONOMOUS	REQUIRED	AGI-operated systems, fully autonomous security platforms, self-directed maintenance systems with complex decision trees	Property with extended monitoring. Operator liable.	Requires operator licence in addition to unit registration. Autonomy level must be declared. Mesh activity is logged. Escalating scrutiny above Class 2.
CLASS 4 INFOMORPH PERSON	REQUIRED	Infomorphs operating without a morph, uploaded persons residing in mesh substrate, fork-persons with legal standing	Recognised person under Outer Alliance law. Independent legal standing.	Registered as a person, not a platform. Must declare hosting substrate. Full legal rights apply including right to counsel, right to ego integrity, and right to register complaints independently. Egocast arrivals scanned under VSC-REG-0442.
CLASS 5 UPLIFT / HYBRID	STANDARD ARRIVAL	Uplift persons (octopus, cetacean, great ape, avian),	Full person under Outer Alliance law.	No separate registration required beyond standard arrival process. Uplift

	hybrid biological-synthetic persons, persons in non-standard morphs	Standard rights apply.	persons are persons. This classification exists solely for operational clarity, not to create a separate legal tier. Vesta Station enforces this without qualification.

◈ VESTA STATION POSITION ON UPLIFT PERSONHOOD

Vesta Station Cooperative recognises all legally uplift persons — including but not limited to octopus, cetacean, great ape, corvid, and avian uplifts — as full persons under Outer Alliance law. No Cooperative regulation creates a lesser status for uplift persons. Any commercial operator, security contractor, or visitor who treats an uplift person as property, equipment, or a lesser legal entity on Vesta Station will be prosecuted under §12 (Assault on Person) and §38 (Unlawful Discrimination) as applicable. **This is not a grey area.**

◈ 3. DRONE AND BOT OPERATIONAL RESTRICTIONS

Class 1 and Class 2 platforms operating within station jurisdiction are subject to the following restrictions regardless of registration status:

◈ ALL DRONES AND AUTONOMOUS PLATFORMS — OPERATIONAL RULES

- **Airspace restriction:** Drone flight within pressurised station sections is prohibited without an engineering or commercial operations permit. The docking ring and all interior commercial sections are no-fly zones for unregistered platforms. Maintenance droids operating on ceiling and wall infrastructure are exempt under active work orders.
- **Surveillance restriction:** A drone or bot equipped with sensors recording third-party persons without consent is operating as a surveillance platform and requires a commercial surveillance licence under VSC-RN-07-04. This applies regardless of the platform's primary stated purpose.
- **Weapons carriage:** Any drone or bot carrying weapons is classified as an armed platform and requires a separate armed platform permit in addition to unit registration. Armed platforms without permits are confiscated. All weapons carriage provisions of VSC-RN-04-23 apply to platforms as to persons.
- **Remote operation disclosure:** A platform being operated remotely by a person not physically present on station must display a visible indicator of remote operation status — a mesh tag readable at 2 metres minimum. Operating a platform covertly as a remote presence without this disclosure is prohibited.
- **Micrograv and exterior zones:** Autonomous platforms operating in exterior hull corridors and docking struts require an engineering permit and must be logged on the active operations register before entering those zones. Unregistered platforms in exterior zones will be assumed hostile and treated accordingly by VSCS.

◈ 4. SYNTHMORPHS — REGISTRATION AND ARRIVAL

Synthmorphs carrying a person — whether a primary ego, a fork, or a ghostrider module — are Class 2 platforms for

registration purposes but the ego within retains the legal status of a person. Registration of the morph does not register the person within it. Both must be declared.

◈ MORPH REGISTRATION — VSC-REG-0442

All synthmorphs must register at the Hub arrival desk within 4 hours of docking. Registration is logged for 90 days. Required information: mesh ID, morph model and serial, registered owner, current occupant if different from owner. Failure to register: 150 cr fine and mandatory registration with VSCS escort.

◈ OCCUPANT DECLARATION

The person occupying a synthmorph must be declared separately from the morph registration. An ego occupying a morph registered to another person or organisation must declare that occupancy. An undeclared occupant discovered during a VSCS inspection is treated as an unregistered infomorph arrival — see Section 5.

◈ GHOSTRIDER MODULES

A ghostrider module carrying a secondary ego within a primary morph must be declared at arrival. The secondary ego has legal personhood and must be registered as an infomorph person. An undisclosed ghostrider is treated as an attempt to smuggle an unregistered person into station jurisdiction. Both the carrier and the carried are subject to investigation.

◈ EMPTY SYNTHMORPHS

A synthmorph brought to station without a current occupant — as cargo, as a spare morph, or as commercial inventory — is Class 2 property and must be registered to its owner. It must be stored in a registered location. An unoccupied synthmorph found in a public area without a logged owner is confiscated pending investigation.

◈ ENFORCEMENT NOTE — CORPORATE SYNTHMORPH REGISTRIES

Security contractors and corporate operators frequently bring worker pod synthmorphs under commercial survey or asset recovery permits. These morphs are on the 90-day registry and their presence, location, and occupant history is logged. **A corporate operator whose synthmorph registry entry is inconsistent with its observed location or occupant at any point during a VSCS inspection has a compliance problem.** This registry entry is public record accessible to any person with a mesh connection to the Hub database. It is leverage, and it is frequently used as such.

◈ 5. INFOMORPHS — ARRIVAL, REGISTRATION, AND LEGAL STATUS

An infomorph arriving on Vesta Station — whether via egocast, carried on a data device, or transferred through a mesh channel — is a person and must be registered as such. The substrate they run on is not their identity. The ego is.

◈ INFOMORPH ARRIVAL AND REGISTRATION

— **Egocast arrivals:** All persons arriving via the Hub egocast terminal are registered automatically. The biometric scan protocol introduced under VSC-REG-0442 runs on all egocast arrivals — criteria undisclosed. The scan is passive and does not require consent; it is a condition of using the licensed terminal.

— **Infomorphs arriving on personal devices:** A person carried on a data chip, personal device, or mesh node and

- **Infomorphs arriving on personal devices:** A person carried on a data chip, personal device, or mesh node and brought into station jurisdiction by another person must be declared at arrival. Undeclared infomorphs on personal hardware discovered during inspection are treated as unregistered arrivals — a 200 cr fine per undisclosed person, and the infomorph is flagged for VSCS monitoring.
- **Forks:** A fork of a registered person is a separate person for registration purposes. Alpha forks with full legal standing must be registered independently. Beta and lesser forks in temporary operational use must be disclosed. A fork operating covertly on station without registration is an unregistered person — see penalties.
- **Infomorphs in distress or without a host substrate:** An infomorph who has lost their host substrate — through hardware failure, confiscation, or hostile action — has the right to emergency hosting at the Hub egocast facility for up to 72 hours at no cost. This right cannot be waived by a third party on behalf of the infomorph. VSCS cannot deny emergency hosting to a person in substrate distress.

◈ NOTE — DAMAGED OR PARTIAL FORKS

A fork that has suffered data loss, corruption, or partial degradation retains full legal personhood regardless of integrity level. A damaged fork is a person. They may not have full access to their memories. They may be disoriented or operating with reduced coherence. **None of this reduces their legal standing.** Any person or operator who treats a damaged fork as equipment, data, or property rather than a person is in violation of §31 (Unlawful Interference with Ego Integrity) and §38 (Unlawful Discrimination). VSCS will treat a complaint from a damaged fork with the same weight as a complaint from any other person.

◈ 6. PROHIBITED SYNTHETIC PLATFORMS

The following synthetic platforms are prohibited from Vesta Station jurisdiction regardless of registration status, operator licence, or commercial permit:

◈ PROHIBITED — SYNTHETIC PLATFORMS

- **TITAN-derived or TITAN-influenced autonomous systems:** Any platform assessed as containing TITAN architecture, TITAN-derived decision logic, or TITAN-influenced autonomous behaviour is prohibited. Detection triggers immediate confiscation, quarantine, and Cooperative Council notification. The former operator is not assumed to have known — but they are detained for investigation regardless.
- **Exsurgent-infected platforms:** Any synthetic platform showing signs of exsurgent infection — anomalous behaviour, unregistered autonomous capability, unexplained mesh activity, or refusal to respond to shutdown commands — is to be reported to VSCS immediately. Do not attempt to interact with, contain, or destroy an exsurgent-suspected platform without VSCS authorisation. VSCS is authorised to use lethal methods.
- **Unregistered armed platforms:** Any drone, bot, or synthetic morph carrying weapons without an armed platform permit is confiscated. The weapons are handled under VSC-RN-04-23. The platform is handled under this Notice. Both apply simultaneously.
- **Platforms configured for covert surveillance without licence:** A synthetic platform whose primary or secondary function is covert surveillance of persons without consent, and which does not hold a commercial surveillance

function is covert surveillance of persons without consent, and which does not hold a commercial surveillance licence, is prohibited. Configuration is assessed by VSCS on inspection — claimed purpose does not override observed capability.

— **Self-replicating synthetic platforms:** Any platform capable of producing functional copies of itself without authorised oversight is prohibited. This includes experimental self-repair systems with replication capability and research prototypes with uncontrolled reproduction functions. See VSC-RN-07-04 §4 for related provisions on replicating agents.

◈ 7. PENALTIES

OFFENCE	OUTCOME
Unregistered Class 2 synthmorph on station	`150 cr fine` + mandatory registration under VSCS escort. Operator permits reviewed.
Undisclosed ghostrider module	`500 cr fine + investigation` — carrier and carried both subject to VSCS inquiry. Carrier's permits suspended pending outcome.
Unregistered infomorph on personal device	`200 cr per undisclosed person` + infomorph flagged for monitoring. If infomorph is a fork of a wanted person: criminal referral.
Unregistered armed drone or bot	`Platform confiscated` + weapons handled under VSC-RN-04-23 + operator liable for all weapons charges.
Drone operating in no-fly zone without permit	`100 cr fine` + platform grounded pending permit review. Repeat offence: confiscation.
Covert remote operation without disclosure indicator	`200 cr fine` + platform flagged. If used for surveillance: licence required or confiscation.
Treatment of uplift or infomorph person as property	`Criminal referral` — §12 and §38. No fine available as an alternative. Prosecution mandatory.
TITAN-derived or exsurgent platform brought to station	`Platform confiscated + quarantine` + operator detained for investigation. Cooperative Council notified. No bail during investigation.

◈ 8. CROSS-REFERENCES

◈ RELATED REGULATORY DOCUMENTS

VSC-RN-04-23 — Firearms Carriage and Discharge Ordinance. Weapons carried by or mounted on synthetic platforms are governed by VSC-RN-04-23 in addition to this Notice. Both apply.

VSC-RN-07-04 — Prohibited Possession and Confiscation Ordinance. Prohibited items found on or within synthetic platforms are handled under VSC-RN-07-04. Prohibited items inside a synthmorph's carried storage do not exempt the morph's operator from liability.

VSC-REG-0442 — The audit regulation introducing the 90-day synthmorph registry and updated egocast biometric scan. Changes in Revision 3 of this Notice directly implement VSC-REG-0442 requirements.

VSE-TB-0291 — Hull Material Integrity Ratings. Relevant for synthetic platforms operating in exterior zones where hull-breach risk applies equally to autonomous platforms and biological persons.

Appeals and registration queries: Office of Cooperative Regulation, Entity Status Division, Level 2 Administration, Vesta Station Cooperative Hub. Mesh: vscreg-entity.vesta.belt // Ref: VSC-RN-03-11. Response time: 15 working days for registration disputes. Emergency substrate hosting requests: Hub egocast facility, 24hr desk.

DIRECTOR OF CIVIL RIGHTS
AND ENTITY STATUS
VESTA STATION COOPERATIVE

DIRECTOR OF PUBLIC SAFETY
OFFICE OF COOPERATIVE
REGULATION

COOPERATIVE COUNCIL
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